



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

Grassroots football · Greater Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

FUNDRAISING RESEARCH · OCTOBER 2026

Sponsor Prospects & Approach Letters

Who to approach for kit, apparel, equipment, hydration, food and money. What other grassroots tournaments in KZN and South Africa do to win sponsors. Letters written for each type of sponsor.

25+

Prospects, grouped by what they can give

6

Tournament models studied, with lessons for Growfit

11

Letters ready to send (L1–L11)

Owner

Khaya Madlala, Fundraising & Registration
Sign-off: Buhle Madlala

Status

Existing partner: Hollywoodbets (match kit)
Research is from public sources. Check contacts and application windows before sending.

1 What other grassroots tournaments do

We looked at how established youth tournaments in KZN and South Africa attract and keep sponsors. The patterns repeat, and most of them are within Growfit's reach.

TOURNAMENT	WHO BACKS IT AND HOW	LESSON FOR GROWFIT
Siyakhula Under-15 Cup (Durban)	The AmaZulu Community Trust and Hollywoodbets , through the Hollywood Foundation, with SAFA eThekwini . Played at Siripat Sports Grounds, Reservoir Hills. Winners received R10,000 in equipment and sponsored match kits . A girls' division was added, and the event was pitched as talent identification.	Co-host with a recognised partner (a PSL club's community trust, the LFA). Give prizes as equipment rather than cash. Sponsors respond to talent identification and inclusion.
Engen Knockout Challenge	One title sponsor (Engen) in partnership with SAFA for more than 20 years. Regional qualifiers lead to finals at major venues. The 2026 KZN leg was at Hollywoodbets Kings Park.	One title sponsor , a long-term relationship and federation approval give credibility. Our Youth Cup should be planned as a recurring, named event.
Kay Motsepe Schools Championship	Sanlam with the Motsepe Foundation and the Department of Basic Education. Prize money (R3m+) is for school sports facilities and equipment.	Corporate, foundation and government together. Prize money tied to development, not individuals. Our schools can enter, a route for players outside the academy.
KZN Premier's Cup	Led by the provincial government. District teams, including two from eThekwini. Framed as youth development and talent identification.	Government is a partner for event support and visibility . Invite the ward councillor and KZN DSR to the Youth Cup.
Danone Nations Cup (U12)	A brand-owned tournament (Danone) tied to a health and nutrition message, with national finals and an international final.	Food and hydration brands like events that link sport to healthy habits . Use this angle with water, juice and food brands.
GDLFA × Mr Price Sport	Mr Price Sport became a Tier-1 sponsor of the Greater Durban LFA (7,500+ players, 108 clubs, 5,600 juniors). Mr Price Sport also ran a grassroots programme with Ukhozi FM and AmaZulu.	Our own LFA already has a sports-retail sponsor. Ask the GDLFA for an introduction, and pair the ask with community media.
Sonani Heritage Cup	We found no public information online. [Add what you know: organiser, sponsors, prizes, how they approached sponsors] .	[Ask the organisers directly: most will share sponsor contacts and what worked.]

Seven habits of tournaments that keep their sponsors

1. **Borrow credibility.** Partner with SAFA eThekweni / GDLFA, a PSL club's community trust, or a school. Sponsors fund what looks safe and well run.
2. **One title sponsor plus category partners.** One headline name, then kit, hydration, equipment, media and food partners, each with a clear, exclusive role.
3. **Prizes in kind.** Equipment, kit and vouchers cost sponsors less and do more for clubs than cash.
4. **Talent identification and inclusion.** Scouts present, a girls' division, and bursary places all make the story easier for a sponsor to tell.
5. **Media.** Community radio (Ukhozi FM), local papers (e.g. Berea Mail) and the clubs' own social pages give sponsors visibility.
6. **Use the official channel.** Big brands run CSI portals with set turnaround times (the Hollywood Foundation replies within about 14 working days). Letters alone often get lost.
7. **Report back and renew.** Photos, numbers and a thank-you within weeks, then the renewal conversation before budgets are set.

2 Prospects by what they can give

Each row lists why the prospect fits, how to approach them, and which letter to use. **HOT** = strongest fit or existing link.

WARM = good fit, needs an introduction. **LATER** = closed or long-term.

A. Kit & apparel

PROSPECT	WHY THEY FIT · HOW TO APPROACH	LETTER	
Hollywoodbets / Hollywood Foundation (existing)	Already gave Growfit match kit. Their foundation sponsors grassroots kits and youth tournaments in KZN. Next ask: training wear, tour kit or Youth Cup support. Apply through the online sponsorship application on hollywoodfoundation.co.za (reply in about 14 working days).	L1	HOT
Mr Price Sport (Durban HQ)	A Durban-based retailer and Tier-1 sponsor of our own LFA (GDLFA). Ask the GDLFA for an introduction to the Mr Price Sport sponsorship team. Ask for training wear or equipment, or a Youth Cup prize partnership.	L2	HOT
The Sports Trust	Delivers kit and equipment to disadvantaged schools and clubs on behalf of corporate funders, branded with the funder's logo. Ask to be listed as a beneficiary club in KZN. Contact: marketing@sportstrust.co.za · 011 802 1818.	L3	WARM
Local kit makers: Susan Reid Design (Umgeni Rd, Durban); Just Brand, Ronex, Casco, GripSport (national)	Ask for a community rate or part-donation in return for "Kit made by" recognition. This makes any cash sponsor's money go further. Durban-made is a good story.	L4	WARM
Totalsports (TFG)	A national sports retailer with community sponsorships (e.g. title sponsor of a grassroots athletics club). Start with the local store manager for vouchers, then head-office marketing for bigger asks.	L5	WARM
Sportsmans Warehouse	Sports retailer with a published sponsorship policy. Read it first, then apply. The local store is the best start for vouchers or end-of-range stock.	L5	WARM

B. Equipment

Hollywood Foundation	Funds sports equipment for registered NPOs, schools and communities. Add equipment to the L1 application.	L1	HOT
Mr Price Sport · Totalsports · Sportsmans Warehouse	Balls, bibs, cones, goals, gloves, as vouchers or stock.	L2 / L5	WARM
eThekweni Grant-in-Aid (Sports sector)	The annual municipal programme funds sports organisations among other sectors (R5.5m in 2026, 418 applications). Watch for the call. Grant-in-Aid Manager: 031 311 2070.	L9	WARM
KZN Dept of Sport & Recreation	Runs a Club Development programme. Ask the district office what equipment or kit support is open to registered clubs. Tel 031 360 6574.	L9	WARM

C. Hydration & food

PROSPECT	WHY THEY FIT · HOW TO APPROACH	LETTER	
aQuellé (KZN-based water brand)	Official water sponsor of COSAFA and Netball SA, and supplies thousands of bottles to sports events each year. Bottles in KZN (Kranskop). Use the contact form on aquelle.co.za . Do reputational due diligence first: the brand is linked to KwaSizabantu Mission, which faced public abuse allegations in 2020.	L6	WARM
Coca-Cola Beverages SA (Valpré water, Powerade)	Strong KZN presence and community programmes, including employee "Soul Ambassadors" volunteers. Ask for Valpré water and Powerade for the Youth Cup and the tour, through the regional office or community channel.	L6	WARM
Energade	Has been official sports drink of SAFA's national teams, so football fits the brand. Ask brand marketing for product for tournaments.	L6	WARM
SPAR (Group head office: Pinetown)	A Durban-headquartered retailer that already sponsors AmaZulu FC. Independent SPAR store owners support local causes, so approach your nearest SPAR owner for fruit, water or vouchers. Head office: 031 719 1900.	L7	HOT
Pick n Pay · Shoprite · Boxer (local stores)	Store-level community budgets: snacks, water and vouchers for match days and camps.	L7	WARM
BB Bakeries · local butchers & bakeries	BB Bakeries has partnered AmaZulu community outreach. Local suppliers for camp snacks and braai-day meat at cost.	L7	WARM

D. Money: corporate CSI, foundations & government

Hollywood Foundation	As above. Cash and kit for Youth Cup and tour asks.	L1	HOT
Toyota South Africa Motors (Prospecton)	Durban's largest manufacturer, with a stated commitment to the community around Prospecton. Ask CSI for tour or programme funding, with a staff-volunteering angle.	L8	WARM
Other large Durban employers: parents' employers, port and logistics firms, banks' local branches	Use parents' links first. A staff member who "brings" the ask is the strongest route. Use the B-BBEE SED angle.	L8	HOT
National Lotteries Commission	Funds sport and recreation, including local clubs. Apply only during an open call.	D9*	WARM
eThekweni Grant-in-Aid · KZN DSR	See section B.	L9	WARM
Motsepe Foundation	Big in school football, but not accepting proposals . It chooses projects itself. Take part through the Kay Motsepe Schools Championship via players' schools.	–	LATER
Transnet Foundation	Strong sport programme, but applications are closed (a moratorium on sponsorships). Check again in 6 months.	–	LATER
Mr Price Foundation	Focuses on youth skills and employability, not sport. Only approach with a life-skills or coaching-qualification project.	–	LATER

*D9 is the grant cover letter in the Donations & Grants pack.

E. Partners, media & services

AmaZulu Community Trust	Co-runs grassroots tournaments (Siyakhula Cup) with SAFA eThekweni and sponsors. Propose co-hosting the Growfit Youth Cup or a coaching clinic.	L10	HOT
SAFA eThekweni / GDLFA	Sanctioning, credibility and sponsor introductions (Mr Price Sport).	L10	HOT
Ukhozi FM · Berea Mail · local community papers	Ukhozi FM has partnered grassroots football programmes before. Media coverage is a benefit we can offer sponsors.	L11	WARM
Medical & transport	Not yet researched: private ambulance or first-aid providers (standby at a community rate), local pharmacies (first-aid kits), taxi associations and bus or air lines for the Gauteng tour.	S8 / T3	WARM

3 Plan for the next 90 days

#	ACTION	OWNER · BY
1	Thank Hollywoodbets for the kit (photos, numbers), then submit a Hollywood Foundation application for the next need (L1).	[name] · week 1–2
2	Ask the GDLFA for introductions to Mr Price Sport and the AmaZulu Community Trust. Send L2 and L10.	[name] · week 2
3	Parents' employer drive: every parent names one employer contact. Send L8 with a personal note.	[name] · week 2–4
4	Visit 3 local stores (SPAR, Pick n Pay, sports retailer) with L7 and L5 printed, plus the one-page fact sheet.	[name] · week 3–4
5	Hydration asks for the Youth Cup: aQuellé (after due diligence), CCBSA, Energade (L6).	[name] · week 4
6	Kit maker community-rate quotes for the Gauteng tour kit (L4). Sports Trust beneficiary request (L3).	[name] · week 4–6
7	Watch for eThekweni Grant-in-Aid, KZN DSR and NLC calls (L9 / D9).	[name] · ongoing
8	Media: pitch the Youth Cup and the tour to Ukhozi FM and local papers (L11).	[name] · 6 weeks before events

Every pack should include

- The covering letter (L1–L11), personalised, with one clear ask and one smaller alternative
- The relevant proposal (Sponsorship pack, Youth Cup, Gauteng Tour or Camps)
- NPC registration certificate, bank confirmation letter, [PBO/NPO certificates if any], SAFA/GDLFA affiliation letter
- 2–3 consented photos (no full names) and the Hollywoodbets kit as proof that sponsors already back us

Brand suitability

Our players are children, so every partner is checked for suitability before we accept support. We follow advertising rules that protect minors, including the gambling-advertising rules. Licensed betting partners are welcome (Hollywoodbets already supports our kit). On children's kit their branding is limited to name and logo, with no betting promotions, odds or calls to action, nothing aimed at under-18s, and no betting branding at North Crest Primary or other school premises.

L1 · HOLLYWOOD FOUNDATION: THANK-YOU & NEXT REQUEST

Send the thank-you now. Use the second part as the motivation text in the online sponsorship application.



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

NPC Reg. No. []

[address]

[email] · [phone]

[Date]

Hollywood Foundation · Hollywoodbets

[Contact name, role]

Dear [Name] ,

Thank you. On behalf of the players, parents and coaches of Growfit Sports Academy, thank you for the match kit Hollywoodbets provided to our teams. Since receiving it, our [squads] have played [number] matches in the Greater Durban Football League. [One result or moment.] Photos are attached.

Our next step. In [month] 2027, our U15 and U17 squads will travel to [tournament] in Gauteng, the first national tournament for most of our 36 players. We will also host the **Growfit Youth Cup**, a holiday tournament for 24 U12–U17 teams from across Durban, modelled on events like the Siyakhula Under-15 Cup.

We would be grateful if the Hollywood Foundation would consider supporting [choose: "training wear and tracksuits for the tour squads (R30,000)" / "equipment prizes for the Growfit Youth Cup (R10,000)" / "the Youth Cup as Headline Partner (R15,000)"] . We will report back with photos, results and a full account of how the support was used.

Our tour and tournament proposals are attached.

With sincere thanks,

Buhle Madlala

Founder & Academy Director, Growfit Sports Academy NPC

L2 · MR PRICE SPORT (VIA GDLFA INTRODUCTION)

[Date]

Dear [Name] ,

[Name at GDLFA] suggested I contact you. Growfit Sports Academy is a non-profit GDLFA member club running U12–U17 teams in Greater Durban. We were glad to see Mr Price Sport come on board as a Tier-1 sponsor of the GDLFA. It means a lot to Durban's junior clubs.

We would like to invite Mr Price Sport to support our players at club level, through [choose: "training wear for 60 players" / "a season's equipment (balls, bibs, cones, goalkeeper gloves) worth R8,000" / "prizes for the Growfit Youth Cup, our 24-team holiday tournament"] . In return, Mr Price Sport would be recognised as [partner title] : logo on [training tops / Youth Cup banners and medals] , social media features, and a presence at our matches and events.

Because sport development for black youth is a recognised socio-economic development activity, we can also provide a B-BBEE beneficiary letter. Our sponsorship proposal is attached. Could we meet for 20 minutes?

Kind regards,

[Name] · Growfit Sports Academy NPC · [phone]

L3 · THE SPORTS TRUST: BENEFICIARY REQUEST

Dear Sports Trust team,

Growfit Sports Academy NPC is a registered non-profit youth football academy in Greater Durban, KwaZulu-Natal. We run U12–U17 teams in the Greater Durban Football League for about [60] players, most of them from [communities] . We are governed by eight adopted policies, including Child Protection & Safeguarding.

We understand the Sports Trust delivers kit and equipment to schools and clubs on behalf of its corporate partners. We would like to be considered as a **beneficiary club in KZN** for [soccer kits / training equipment: balls, bibs, cones, goals] . We would welcome the funder's branding on any kit, report on use and impact, and host a handover with photos.

Our registration documents and a short profile are attached. Thank you for considering Growfit.

Kind regards,

[Name] · [Role] · [phone] · [email]

L4 · KIT MANUFACTURER: COMMUNITY RATE / PART-DONATION

Dear [Name] ,

Growfit Sports Academy, a non-profit youth football academy in Durban, needs [number] custom sublimated kits (shirt, shorts and socks with names, numbers and logos) and [number] tracksuits for our U15 and U17 squads, ahead of a national tournament in Gauteng in [month] 2027.

Could [Company] quote at a **community rate**, or donate part of the order? In return, we would credit [Company] as our **Official Kit Maker**: a small "made by" mark on the kit where allowed, tags in all kit-launch and tour posts, and a recommendation to the 24 clubs at our Growfit Youth Cup. **[If Durban-made: "We'd love our players to wear kit made in Durban."]**

Delivery needed by [date] . Size breakdown and design brief attached.

Kind regards,

[Name] · [phone]

L5 · SPORTS RETAILER STORE (TOTALSPORTS / SPORTSMANS WAREHOUSE / MR PRICE SPORT)

Print and take it to the store manager in person, with the one-page fact sheet.

Dear Store Manager,

I'm [name] from Growfit Sports Academy, a non-profit football academy whose players and families shop in [area] . We are asking local sports stores to help keep our [60] young players equipped this season.

Could your store support us with **[a R2,000 equipment voucher / 10 match balls / end-of-range boots for our boot bank / prizes for our holiday tournament]** ? We would thank your store on our social media and at our matches, and encourage our families to shop with you. If store-level support isn't possible, could you refer us to your regional marketing team?

Thank you,

[Name] · [phone]

L6 · HYDRATION BRAND (WATER / SPORTS DRINK)

Dear [Name / Brand team] ,

Growfit Sports Academy is a non-profit youth football academy in Greater Durban. Healthy habits are part of how we coach: water before, during and after every session. We are inviting [Brand] to be the **Official Hydration Partner** of:

- the **Growfit Youth Cup**, [date] : 24 teams and about 360 players over one day (about [1,000] bottles), and/or
- our **Gauteng Tour 2027**: 42 travellers for 5 days, and/or
- our weekly **training and home matches** for [60] players.

In return: "Hydration Partner" branding at water points and on banners, a sampling stand at the Youth Cup, social media features, and mention in our post-event report. We would also welcome your staff volunteers on the day.

Our tournament proposal is attached. Thank you for considering it.

Kind regards,

[Name] · Growfit Sports Academy NPC · [phone]

L7 · SUPERMARKET STORE OWNER (SPAR / PICK N PAY / SHOPRITE)

Dear [Owner / Manager name] ,

Many of the families at Growfit Sports Academy, a non-profit youth football academy, shop at your store in [area] . We are asking you to support our young players with [fruit and water for Sunday home matches this term / snacks for 48 children at our holiday camp on [dates] / a R1,500 voucher for the Growfit Youth Cup] .

We would proudly thank [Store name] as a **Community Partner** on our social media, on a banner at our matches and in our tournament programme. We would also encourage our families to keep supporting your store.

Thank you for being part of our community,

[Name] · [phone]

Strongest when a staff member or parent forwards it internally. Add their name in the first line.



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

NPC Reg. No. []

[email] · [phone]

[Date]

[Name, CSI / Marketing Manager]

[Company]

Dear [Name] ,

[Colleague / parent name] , whose child plays for us, suggested I write to you. Growfit Sports Academy NPC is a registered non-profit youth football academy in Greater Durban, founded in 2023, running teams from U12 to U17 in the Greater Durban Football League.

We are seeking [R amount] from [Company] 's social investment budget toward [the Gauteng Tour 2027 / the Growfit Youth Cup / a season of equipment and transport] . This would [outcome with numbers] .

For [Company] , this offers: recognition as [package] ; a contribution that may count toward **B-BBEE socio-economic development** (at least 75% of our beneficiaries are black youth, and we provide the beneficiary letter); a staff volunteering opportunity; and a clear report on impact and spending.

The relevant proposal is enclosed. I would welcome a short meeting.

Yours sincerely,

Buhle Madlala, Founder & Academy Director

To: **[eThekweni Grant-in-Aid Manager / KZN DSR eThekweni District, Club Development]**

Dear **[Name]**,

Growfit Sports Academy NPC (Reg. **[]**) is a registered youth football academy in **[ward / area]**, affiliated to the Greater Durban LFA under SAFA eThekweni. We develop about **[60]** young players under eight adopted policies, including Child Protection & Safeguarding.

We would like to **[apply for the Sports sector of the Grant-in-Aid programme / be considered for Club Development support]** for **[project: equipment, kit, coaching courses, the Growfit Youth Cup]**, at a value of **[R]**. Please advise us of the current application process and deadlines. Our registration documents are attached.

We would also be honoured to welcome the **[Department / ward councillor]** at the Growfit Youth Cup on **[date]**.

Yours faithfully,

Buhle Madlala, Founder & Academy Director · **[phone]**

Dear **[Name, AmaZulu Community Trust / GDLFA / SAFA eThekweni]**,

Growfit Sports Academy, a non-profit GDLFA member club, admires the work behind grassroots events such as the **Siyakhula Under-15 Cup**. We are planning the **Growfit Youth Cup**: a one-day holiday tournament for 24 U12–U17 teams from across Durban on **[date]** at **[venue]**, with qualified referees, first aid and safeguarding.

We would like to invite **[organisation]** to **[co-host / endorse / send scouts and coaches to]** the tournament. Possible roles include a coaching clinic for players, a talent-identification presence, help with sanctioning and referees, or an introduction to sponsors. Partners would be credited in all event materials.

Our tournament proposal is attached. Could we meet to discuss?

Kind regards,

Buhle Madlala · **[phone]**

Subject: Story & media partnership: Durban youth football [Youth Cup / Gauteng Tour]

Hi [Name] ,

Growfit Sports Academy, a non-profit grassroots football academy in [area] , is [hosting the Growfit Youth Cup for 24 teams on [date] / taking 36 young players to a national tournament in Gauteng] . We'd love [station/paper] to be our **media partner**: a pre-event interview, a mention on the day, and a results story. In return, your logo goes on our banners and programme, and you get exclusive photos and access to coaches and (consented) players.

Could we set up a quick call?

[Name] · [phone]

Sources

- Siyakhula U15 Cup (AmaZulu Community Trust, Hollywoodbets, SAFA eThekweni): <https://hollywoodfoundation.co.za/programmes/sponsorship/soccer-sponsorships/amazulu-community-trust-and-hollywoodbets-unite-for-inclusive-youth-football-siyakhula-under-15-cup/>
- Hollywood Foundation applications: <https://hollywoodfoundation.co.za/applications/csi-application/>
- Engen Knockout Challenge: <https://engensports.co.za/engen-knockout-challenge/> · <https://ssschoolsplus.co.za/engen-knockout-challenge-ready-to-kick-off-in-kzn/>
- Kay Motsepe Schools Championship: <https://kaymotsepe.com/about-us/> · Motsepe Foundation FAQ (not accepting proposals): <https://www.motsepefoundation.org/resources/faq/>
- KZN Premier's Cup 2025: <https://www.kznonline.gov.za/>
- Danone Nations Cup: <https://www.danonenationscup.com/en/country/za/boy>
- GDLFA × Mr Price Sport: <https://sportswire.co.za/mr-price-sport-and-the-greater-durban-local-football-association/> · Ukhozi FM / AmaZulu: <https://risingsunnewspapers.co.za/321661/>
- The Sports Trust: <https://www.thesportstrust.co.za/>
- Susan Reid Design (Durban kit maker): <https://susanreiddesign.co.za/sports-kit/>
- aQuellé: <https://aquelle.co.za/about-us/> · COSAFA water sponsor: <https://cosafa.com/cosafa-welcomes-aquelle-as-water-sponsor-in-2022/>
- CCBSA community: <https://www.ccbagroup.com/> · Energade × SAFA: <https://www.isportconnect.com/energade-become-official-sports-drink-of-south-african-football-association/>
- SPAR sponsorships: <https://www.spar.co.za/Lifestyle/Sponsorship-Application-Portal/Sponsorships>
- Transnet Foundation (applications closed): <https://transnetfoundation.co.za/grants-donations.html>
- eThekweni Grant-in-Aid 2026: <https://iol.co.za/news/south-africa/kwazulu-natal/2026-04-15-concerns-over-ethekweni-municipalities-r55-million-grant-in-aid-programme/>
- Gambling advertising and minors: <https://www.ngb.org.za/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/NGB-Statement-Gambling-Advertising.pdf> · <https://www.businessday.co.za/news/2026-02-19-new-gambling-advertising-rules-expected-by-july/>